Marcus Thompson

Cloud Solutions Architect

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SUMMARY

Cloud solutions architect with 14 years in infrastructure and 8 years designing AWS and Azure platforms for regulated enterprises. Known for pragmatic migration plans, strong security design and clear communication with executives and engineers alike.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud platforms: AWS (Organizations, Control Tower, VPC, Transit Gateway, EC2, EKS, Lambda, S3, RDS, DynamoDB, CloudFormation), Microsoft Azure (AKS, Entra ID, Azure Functions, Cosmos DB)
Architecture: Landing zones, multi-account strategy, hub-and-spoke networking, disaster recovery, high availability, event-driven design, microservices, serverless
Infrastructure as code: Terraform, CloudFormation, CDK, Ansible, Packer
Security and governance: IAM design, KMS, SCPs, AWS Config, GuardDuty, Security Hub, SOC 2, HIPAA, PCI DSS, zero trust
Cost and operations: FinOps, Savings Plans, tagging strategy, CloudWatch, Datadog, Splunk
Languages: Python, Bash, PowerShell, SQL

EXPERIENCE

Principal Cloud Architect, *Ironbridge Financial Services* **Mar 2020 - Present**

- Designed an AWS landing zone with 60 accounts, service control policies and centralized logging; passed SOC 2 Type II and PCI DSS audits without findings in networking or identity.
- Led migration of 140 applications from two data centers to AWS over 22 months using rehost, replatform and refactor patterns; retired 1,100 servers and saved $4.8M per year.
- Defined the reference architecture for event-driven services on EKS, Kafka and Lambda, adopted by 9 product teams.
- Built a FinOps program with tagging policy, Savings Plans and monthly reviews, reducing cloud spend growth from 35% to 9% year over year.
- Designed cross-region disaster recovery with a 15-minute RPO and 1-hour RTO for the payments platform and ran two full failover exercises.
- Mentored 6 engineers through AWS certifications and chaired the architecture review board.

Senior Solutions Architect, *Alder Consulting* **Jan 2016 - Feb 2020**

- Delivered cloud strategy and migration roadmaps for 14 enterprise clients in healthcare, energy and retail.
- Designed HIPAA-compliant data platforms on AWS using encrypted S3, KMS, private networking and audited access.
- Wrote CloudFormation and Terraform libraries reused across 30 engagements, cutting delivery time by about 25%.
- Ran workshops with executive stakeholders to align cost, risk and delivery timelines.

Infrastructure Engineer, *Delmar Manufacturing* **Jun 2010 - Dec 2015**

- Managed VMware clusters, SAN storage and Windows and Linux servers for 4 plants.
- Automated patching and backups with PowerShell and Bash, cutting manual work by 15 hours per week.
- Designed the first hybrid network connection between the plants and Azure.

PROJECTS

Internal tool: Account Vending Machine *(Python, Step Functions, Terraform)*

- Self-service account creation with baseline security controls in 12 minutes instead of 2 weeks.

EDUCATION

B.S. Information Systems, Peachtree State University (2010)

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional
- AWS Certified Security - Specialty
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert
- TOGAF 9 Foundation